FRADY from 1A

then went home and fell asleep, assuming that he had spent the night at a friend's house.

When Levi did not return home the next day, friends helped the family search. His twin sister found his bike in a ditch off Little Mill Road, a well-traveled two-lane road between Hwys. 306 and 369. The Forsyth County Sheriff's Office was called, and personnel from several state and local agencies launched an urgent search.

However, it was hunters who, later that same Thursday, found Levi's body some 15 miles away in the Dawson forest.

He had been shot to death.

The Georgia Bureau of Investigation and the sheriffs' offices from both counties teamed up on the murder investigation, following tips and leads that led nowhere.

The physical evidence was "little to none," Paxton said.

"There were a couple of shell casings," he said.

Asked if any DNA evidence had been found on the boy's body, the sheriff shook his head.

Investigators do not believe this was the act of a serial killer.

"A serial killer is a serial killer. You've got to have more than one," Paxton said. "There is always going to be evidence to allow us to say this is the work of one person. The problem we had in the Levi Frady case is there had never been before or since another case like it."

Based on the lack of other injuries to the body, there is no reason to believe that someone accidentally hit the child with a car as he was pedaling his bike and in an act of desperation tried to cover up the mishap by killing him, according to the sheriff.

And though the murder appears almost to have been execution-style, in the five years since the death, no motive for something like that has emerged.

Capt. Ron Freeman, commander of the sheriff's office's criminal investigations division, said Friday that new leads in the case continue to come in periodically.

"We were out doing interviews this week," he said, adding that the interviews were for background information, not to interview any suspects.

> ***"The problem we had in the Levi Frady case is there had never been before or since another case like it. – Forsyth County Sheriff Ted Paxton"***

"We've not targeted in on a specific suspect at this time," Freeman said.

One of the new faces in the investigative team is that of John Cagle, the newly appointed special agent in charge of the Gainesville Regional Office of the GBI.

In an interview Friday afternoon, Cagle said the Frady case was the first one he picked up when he assumed his new position three weeks ago.

"I went to the crime scene yesterday, with our case agent," Cagle said, adding that he also has read all 50 volumes of evidence in the case."

He reiterated that the killer is still being actively pursued.

"Although it's an old case, and at least to this point unsolved and is discouraging certainly for family members and discouraging for the police officers who have working on his case — believe me, they have really wrestled with it; a lot of the agents working on it have children of a similar age — I can assure the community over there, we're still working this case as hard as we did when it first happened ... "

"In fact, I had an agent today running down a lead on it," Cagle said.

The one good thing that has come out of the tragedy is the creation of a statewide emergency alert system for abducted children that is called "Levi's Call."

According to Vicki Metz of the GBI Public Affairs Office, the program is a partnership of her agency, Georgia Emergency Management Agency and the Georgia Association of Broadcasters. Recently, the Georgia Department of Transportation also has agreed to post alerts on its changeable message signs, Metz said.

"The name Levi's Call came from us wanting to remember one of our own on behalf of all missing and murdered children in Georgia," she added.

Only once has since its activation in January has the system been used. That was during a Florida child's abduction in which the perpetrator brought the child to Georgia and, then, after Levi's Call became activated, turned his car around and went back to Florida.

That child was returned unharmed.



Source: Georgia Bureau of Investigations

Investigators are seeking the public's help in identifying two possible witnesses in the 1997 murder of Levi Frady. The first person was seen walking along Little Mill Road at 6:30 p.m. on the day the boy was first missed. The man is described as white in his late 50s, with a scruffy, gray beard. He was wearing a faded blue baseball cap. He walked in a stooped fashion. The second potential witness, right, was seen in the Dawson Forest Wildlife Management Area. He is described as white, 45-55, clean shaven, 6-feet tall, slim build with white or gray hair. He was driving a 1980 to 1985 medium blue Toyota, pick-up truck with a white camper shell over the bed of the vehicle. Anyone with information is asked to call (800) 432-9284 or by write: Levi Frady Case 189, Hwy. 53 West, Suite 201, Dawsonville, GA 30534.

LAST DAYS

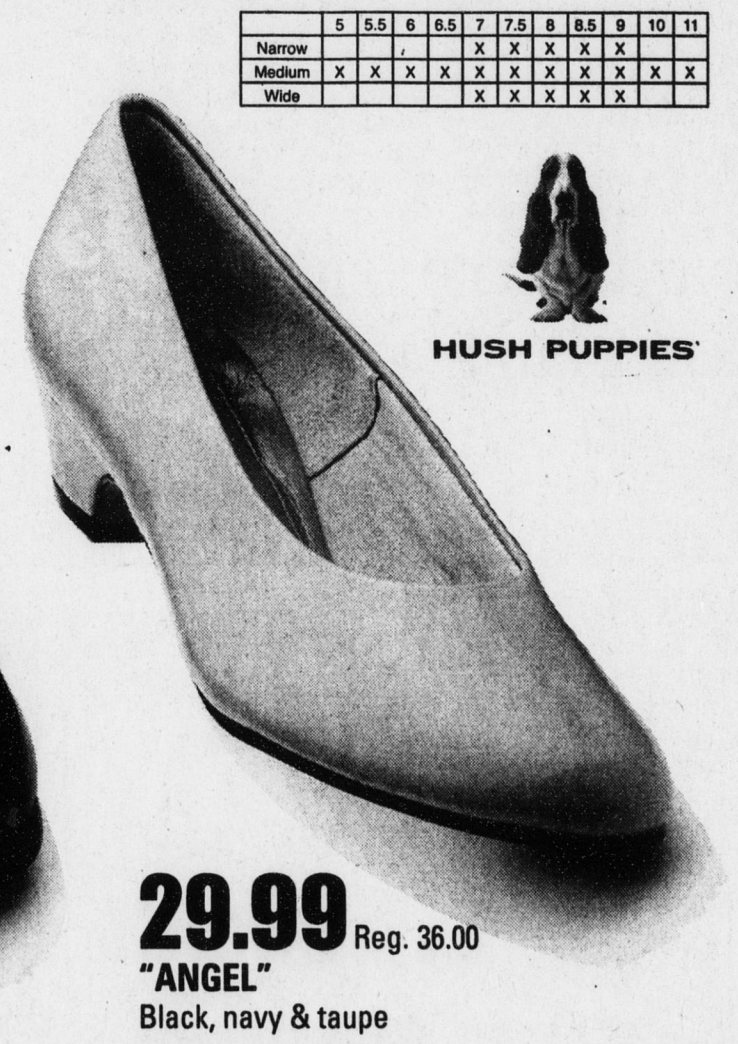
BELK DAYS OUR BIGGEST SALE OF THE YEAR!

HUSH PUPPIES® FOR WOMEN

	5	5.5	6	6.5	7	7.5	8	8.5	9	10	11
Narrow					X	X	X	X	X		
Medium	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Wide					X	X	X	X	X		



39.99 Reg. 49.99
"HEAVEN"
Black, navy & taupe



29.99 Reg. 36.00
"ANGEL"
Black, navy & taupe



29.99 Reg. 39.00
"JANISE"
Brown & black

29.99 Reg. 39.00
"SASHAY"
Black, navy & taupe

39.99 Reg. 55.00
"ISIS"
Black, navy & taupe

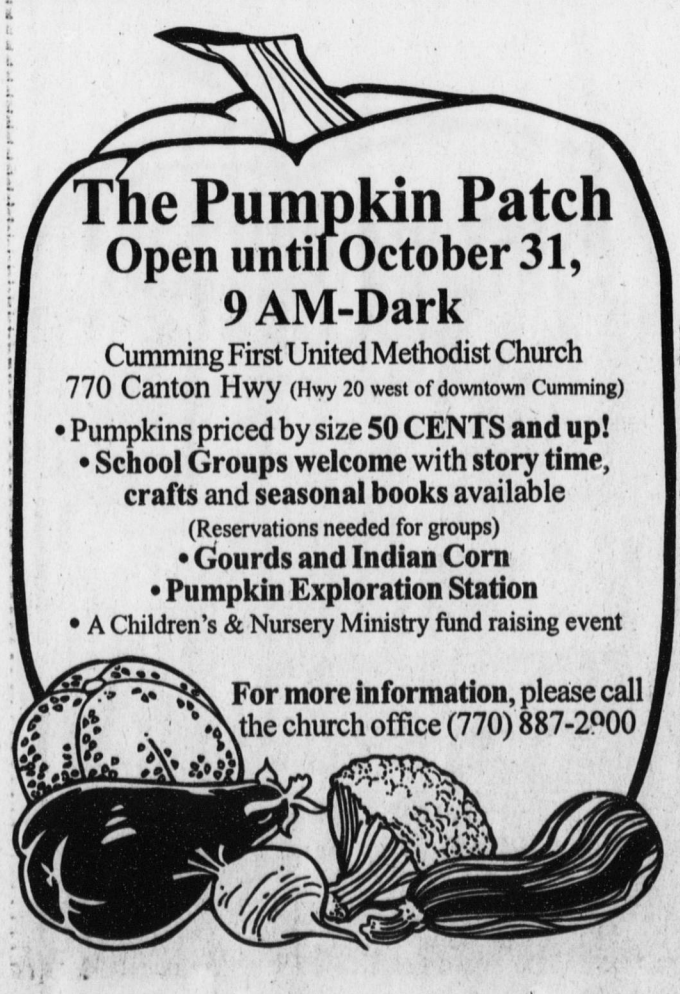
Belk All For You!
belk.com

GA 400 • Exit 14 • Lakeland Plaza • Cumming • (770) 889-5998 • Mon-Sat 10 - 9, Sun 12 - 6
Colonial Lakeshore Mall • Gainesville • (770) 532-7021 • Mon-Sat 10-9, Sun Noon-6
Convenient Belk Charge - VISA, Mastercard & American Express

VOTE FOR
STEPHENS
SCHOOL BOARD
ON NOV. 5
Paid for by Stephens for School Board Committee • 101 Samaritan Drive, Cumming, GA 30040

CWA Systems & Solutions
Networking
Telephones
Wiring
770.753.7900
AVAYA communication
BUSINESS PARTNER
Authorized Agent of BellSouth Telecommunications
BELLSOUTH®
www.cwa-inc.com

Networking
Computer Systems
Wireless Networks
Internet Service
Consulting/Design
Telephones
Telephone Systems
Voice Mail
Moving & Setup
Consulting/Design
Wiring
Home & Office
Voice & Data
Consulting/Design



The Pumpkin Patch
Open until October 31,
9 AM-Dark
Cumming First United Methodist Church
770 Canton Hwy (Hwy 20 west of downtown Cumming)
• Pumpkins priced by size 50 CENTS and up!
• School Groups welcome with story time, crafts and seasonal books available
(Reservations needed for groups)
• Gourds and Indian Corn
• Pumpkin Exploration Station
• A Children's & Nursery Ministry fund raising event
For more information, please call the church office (770) 887-2900